

Region swelters in hot, humid misery

Temperatures will rise to the 90s and higher, and moist air will persist, forecasters say.

By Karen Garcia

What experts describe as some of the worst humidity they've ever recorded in Southern California gripped the region Tuesday, making already hot, miserable conditions feel even worse.

The extreme weather, a preview of the intense El Niño conditions forecast for the Southland this winter, will keep temperatures in the 90s and 100s in some areas for several days. The coast will offer little respite, with high surf, intense temperatures and ocean pollution due to the rain.

Tuesday's humidity was punishing, with dew points hitting 76 degrees in Long Beach, Huntington Beach and Newport Beach after 12 p.m.

The National Weather Service office in Oxnard, which issues forecasts for L.A. County, doesn't keep records for dew point or relative humidity. But one meteorologist there, Richard Thompson, who has been forecasting for more than three decades, said that "this current dew point/humidity condition is among the most oppressive that I can remember."

Tropical Storm Marie off the Pacific Ocean is a key reason for the conditions.

"All of that tropical moisture is really coming from [the remnants of Marie] leaning into our area," and at the same time a ridge of high pressure will build into the region from the east over the next several days, said Kristan Lund, a meteorologist with the weather service's Oxnard office.

Many communities in the coastal parts of the region experienced isolated showers and thunderstorms on Tuesday.

Marie has been reduced to a low-pressure system that is still spinning offshore [See Humid, A9]



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GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

SEAN ZABRISKIE and son Connor, 7, shop for hockey gear in Harbor City with the help of Ian Davis. At top, trucks cross into Detroit from Windsor, Canada.

Border crackdown drives smugglers underground

Tunnels offer faster, safer crossing from Mexico

By Steve Fisher

MEXICO CITY — When the Trump administration announced this summer that illegal crossings into the U.S. from Mexico had reached historical lows, Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin declared, "Our border is CLOSED to lawbreakers."

Even so, the administration continues to pressure both Mexico and U.S. officials serving there — publicly and behind the scenes — to curb illegal immigration further. The crackdown has prompted smugglers to become more creative, turning more often to tunnels once reserved for transporting drugs.

Stephen Miller, the main architect of President Trump's immigration policies, has been in near-daily communication

with senior U.S. law enforcement officials, including the U.S. ambassador to Mexico, Ronald Johnson, looking for new ways to stop migrants from entering the United States, according to people familiar with the conversations.

An average of 400 migrants were apprehended while crossing into the U.S. every day in July, according to data by U.S. Customs and Border Patrol. It's a precipitous drop from the thousands who crossed daily at the peak of a migrant surge in 2022.

Sometimes the number of crossings has dropped to 200 a day. But for Miller, that reduction is still not enough, said sources not authorized to speak publicly about internal [See Tunnels, A4]

Canada launches retaliatory tariffs on U.S. products

Strained relations plummet further as Trump hurls insults, claims a 'trade scam.'

By Michael Wilner, Ana Ceballos and Annika Duneja

WASHINGTON — A trade war between the United States and Canada entered a new phase Tuesday as Ottawa's retaliatory tariffs on American goods took effect, escalating a dispute that has steadily strained relations between the allies.

Canada's tariffs, which came into force just after midnight, cover roughly \$20 billion in U.S. goods and impose duties of as much as 50% on products, from steel and aluminum to farm equipment, clothing and electronics. The list also reaches into the everyday commerce that binds the two economies, including cheese, seafood and cosmetics.

It was the latest sign that relations between the two neighbors have reached their lowest point in decades, after Trump dismissed Canada as the 51st American state, moved to rename

Lake Ontario and mocked its armed forces.

Ottawa's latest measures are a response to tariffs imposed by President Trump last month on Canadian exports. The two governments had appeared close to a trade deal just a month ago. But talks broke down in dramatic fashion, leaving both sides aggrieved and accusing the other of negotiating in bad faith.

In a post Tuesday, Trump said Canada "has been ripping us off for years" and threatened to respond by removing access for Canadian businesses to key American markets.

"What many do not realize is that the Canadian Government, including Canadian Provinces, have banned American Small Businesses and Companies from selling into their Government Procurement Markets," Trump wrote. "This is the case even though Canada gets broad access into the massive American Government Procurement Market, including those of our States."

"That is not reciprocity, it is a Canadian Trade Scam. From now on, NO RECIPROCITY — NO ACCESS!" he continued. "I am hereby directing the [General Services Administration], work- [See Canada, A8]



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FOREIGN Secretary Ed Miliband condemned the actions of "settler terrorists" against Palestinians.

U.K. bans Israeli settlement goods

France and Canada plan to take similar action to support a two-state solution.

By Jill Lawless

LONDON — The United Kingdom on Tuesday banned trade with Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank, where it says "settler terrorists" are carrying out "ethnic cleansing" of Palestinians, in a significant toughening of Britain's stance toward a longtime ally.

France and Canada announced they would take similar action in an attempt to prevent expanding settlements and growing violence from making it impossible to establish a future Palestinian state.

Israel responded angrily and said it would close the British Consulate in Jerusalem.

Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said the U.K. will ban imports of all goods

from the settlements and bar companies from providing services for the settlements, including financing, construction, infrastructure, real estate and advertising.

"I do not believe the British people want us supporting the occupation by accepting products from settlements in our shops and supermarkets," Miliband said.

In a joint statement, British Prime Minister Andy Burnham, French President Emmanuel Macron and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said settlement expansion and settler violence in the West Bank "pose a direct and urgent threat" to the two-state solution. They said they decided to act "before it is too late."

The economic impact is likely to be limited, since the settlements produce only a small amount of largely agricultural exports. But the move is a symbolic expression of displeasure with Israel by some of its closest allies, and it offers a new sign [See Israel, A4]

Voices MARK Z. BARABAK COLUMNIST

Fixing California's broken recall system

Is a hissy fit worth \$200 million?

That was the tab in 2021 when California held a recall election less than a year before Gov. Gavin Newsom was set to face voters.

There was angst — the COVID-19 pandemic was raging. There was anger — the lifesaving restrictions imposed by Washington and Sacramento made daily living a chore and drove many small businesses to the brink. Others went clear over the edge.

There was also no small amount of political opportunism at play.

The recall gave Newsom's critics, mainly on the



JUSTIN SULLIVAN Getty Images

THE FAILED effort to unseat Gov. Gavin Newsom underscored the flaws in the state's recall system.

right, a chance to try to chase the Democrat from an office that Republicans, under normal circumstances, stood little chance of winning.

In the end, the recall effort amounted to scarcely more than a partisan tantrum. The result — 61.9% voting no, 38.1% voting yes — matched the outcome of the 2018 gubernatorial race down to the decimal. All that money and effort wasted on an election in which voters said pretty much, yep, we meant what we said. Not too long after, they gave Newsom a second term.

The plebiscite, and its [See Barabak, A8]

Smithsonian leader to step down

Lonnie Bunch is exiting as Trump administration pushes the institution to recast history. NATION, A6

Threat of a mass stranding of pups

A powerful El Niño could bring an influx of underfed sea lions — again. CALIFORNIA, B1

Weather

Sunshine; very hot. L.A. Basin: 102/76. B6

Markets A12

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Quarterback questions aplenty

The NFL season starts with play-callers looking to prove themselves. SPORTS, B10

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Salvadorans anxiously await news on TPS

By Andrea Castillo and Itzel Luna

Thousands of longtime immigrants from El Salvador and their loved ones are anxiously awaiting word from the Trump administration about whether they will face the possibility of deportation if their temporary legal protections expire as scheduled Wednesday.

The Department of

Homeland Security has not yet announced whether it will end or extend Temporary Protected Status for some 170,000 Salvadorans, including 36,000 in California. But federal officials have targeted for arrest other immigrant groups whose TPS expired.

Since their status ended in July, many Haitians have been outfitted with ankle monitors and some have already been sent back to the

politically unstable country plagued by gang violence.

As federal officials have whittled down the countries that still qualify for Temporary Protected Status, Salvadorans make up the largest population of remaining beneficiaries.

Just over 100,000 people from Sudan, Ukraine and Lebanon still have TPS protections until later this year, the vast majority of them Ukrainians.

Under TPS, recipients are able to obtain permits allowing them to work legally in the country. More than 150,000 U.S. citizen children nationwide have Salvadoran parents with TPS.

Asked by The Times about the administration's plans regarding TPS for Salvadorans, border advisor Tom Homan said he does not know and that the decision is up to Homeland Security. [See TPS, A8]